

240Hz, which is great as it enables the Dynamic Refresh Rate option in Windows, a really helpful feature for conserving battery life.

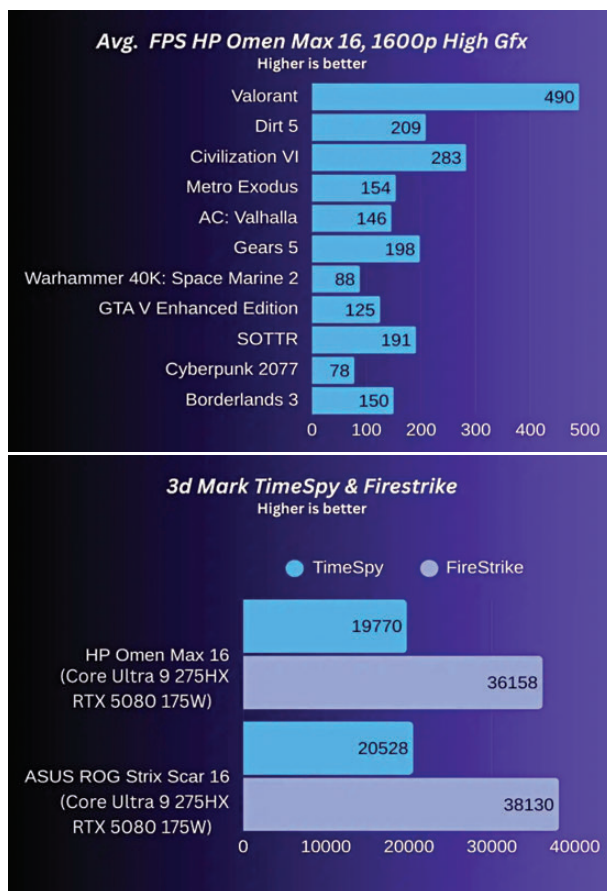
The HP Omen Max 16 features dual HyperX-tuned speakers, DTS:X Ultra spatial audio, and HP Audio Boost 2.0, all aiming to deliver immersive, high-quality sound. In reality, though, real-world feedback is mixed. One major complaint I have with the speaker system is the volume—when the laptop fans spin at full speed, they drown out the audio.

BENCHMARK

In the standalone Cinebench R23 test, the Intel Core Ultra 9 275HX scores 33,549 in the multicore and 2,142 in the single-core test. In comparison, the ASUS ROG Strix Scar 16, powered by the same processor, scores 36,543 in multicore and 2,240 in single-core tests. What's really interesting here is that, compared to the ROG Strix Scar 16, the average CPU temperature in the Omen Max 16 is around 1–2 degrees higher, sitting at approximately 97°C.

However, when we switch to performance mode on both laptops, the HP Omen Max 16 and the ASUS ROG Strix Scar 16 both hover around 80 degrees, with much more bearable fan noise as well. This test highlights that the Intel Core Ultra 9 275HX can be unleashed at full power, but even at a lower TDP, its efficiency remains impressive. And in the context of gaming laptops, this is where efficiency truly comes into play.

For instance, and let's be honest, you're not going to get 10+ hours of battery life on a gaming laptop. But what you will get is more CPU performance even at a lower power draw, along with manageable temperatures, so you can sustain that performance indefinitely. That's where the Intel Core Ultra 9 275HX shines—but if you're not careful, it can get pretty hot, pretty quickly.



As for the Nvidia GeForce RTX 5080 GPU, it performed very well, with some caveats, in our Digit Ultimate Gaming Test, delivering excellent results in over 10 games at both 1200p and 1600p resolutions. Most notably, it scored around 300 FPS in Civilization VI, 217 FPS in Dirt 5, and 214 FPS in Shadow of the Tomb Raider. Furthermore, at 1600p, the laptop scored 283 FPS in Civilization VI, 209 FPS in Dirt 5, and 191 FPS in Shadow of the Tomb Raider.

Similarly, in terms of 3D benchmarks like TimeSpy and Fire Strike, the HP Omen Max 16 lags ever so slightly behind the ROG Strix Scar 16, scoring 19,770 in TimeSpy and 36,158 in Fire Strike. Meanwhile, the ROG Strix Scar 16 scores 20,528 and 38,130, respectively. Both these tests CPU and GPU performance together, so there is a possibility that the slightly higher CPU temps on the HP Omen Max 16 are dulling its score by a small margin -- at least in our testing and benchmark analysis.

However, when we compare the pricing of both laptops, the HP Omen Max 16 is easily around ₹79,000 cheaper than the ASUS ROG Strix Scar 16 for the Intel Core Ultra 9 275HX and RTX 5080 variant. One notable specification advantage the Strix Scar 16 has is the Mini-LED display and an additional 1TB of storage, which comes by default.

CONCLUSION

The HP Omen Max 16 is a bold step forward for HP's gaming lineup, delivering desktop-level performance in a sleek, redesigned chassis. With standout specs like the Intel Core Ultra 9 275HX, RTX 5080 GPU, and a vapor chamber cooling system, it's clear HP isn't just playing catch-up, they're setting a new bar for value in the high-end gaming segment. While it does fall slightly behind rivals like the ASUS ROG Strix Scar 16 in benchmarks, the nearly

₹79,000 lower price tag makes the HP Omen Max 16 a very compelling choice for serious notebook gamers.

—Yetnesh Dubey

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Intel Core Ultra 9 275HX (up to 5.4 GHz with Intel Turbo Boost Technology, 36 MB L3 cache, 24 cores, 24 threads) | Graphics: NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5080 (16 GB) | Memory: 32 GB DDR5-5600 MT/s (2 x 16 GB) | Display: 16" WQXGA (2560 x 1600), 60-240 Hz, 3 ms response time, IPS, micro-edge, anti-glare | Storage: 1 TB PCIe Gen5 NVMe Performance M.2 SSD | Battery: 6-cell, 83 Wh Li-ion polymer

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